

Q.30 What is the importance of Vocabulary Building? State your reasons in brief with relevant examples.

GTU : Summer-19, Marks 3

Ans. : Importance of vocabulary building :

1. **Enhances communication skills :** A strong vocabulary improves both spoken and written communication. (E.g., A well-spoken person uses precise words like elated instead of just happy.)
2. **Boosts academic and professional success :** A good vocabulary helps in exams, presentations, and workplace interactions.
3. **Improves comprehension :** Understanding complex texts becomes easier when vocabulary is rich,
4. **Makes writing more effective :** It enables writers to express ideas clearly and persuasively.
5. **Aids in competitive exams :** Many entrance and aptitude tests have vocabulary-based sections.

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Unit 3

3

Developing Basic Writing Skill

Syllabus

Styles of Writing, Paragraph Writing: elements and Practice, Object / Picture / Scene Description, Précis writing, Proof Reading, Completion of given story, Letter Writing (Formats, Asking for leave, Apology, Appreciation, acknowledgement.

Contents

- 3.1 Introduction
- 3.2 Styles of Writing
- 3.3 Paragraph Writing : Elements and Practice
- 3.4 Object / Picture / Scene Description
- 3.5 Précis Writing
- 3.6 Proofreading
- 3.7 Completion of a Given Story
- 3.8 Letter Writing (Formats, Asking for Leave, Apology, Appreciation, Acknowledgement)
- 3.9 University Questions with Answers

Learning objectives :

- To provide a solid foundation in essential writing techniques and formats.
- To develop clarity, coherence, and creativity in written communication.
- To practice and improve skills in paragraph writing, précis writing, and proofreading.
- To develop an understanding of effective letter writing for a variety of purposes.
- To encourage creative thinking through story completion and descriptive writing.

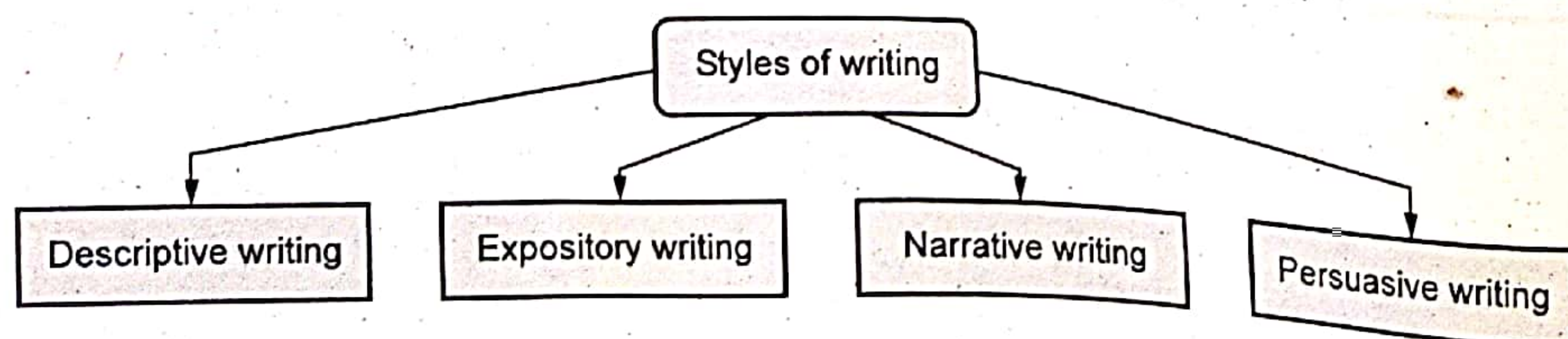
3.1 Introduction

Developing basic writing skills is an important requirement for effective communication in academic and professional contexts. This unit is about equipping learners with the basic tools to communicate their ideas clearly, concisely, and creatively. The unit will take the learner through understanding different writing styles, mastering techniques such as paragraph construction, descriptive writing, précis writing, and proofreading. There are also more practical activities like filling out stories and composing various kinds of letters to help in creativity as well as real - world application.

3.2 Styles of Writing

The term styles of writing refers to different techniques or ways by which authors can convey their thoughts and achieve specific purposes through the writing. Each style of writing is tailored to the content, audience, and objectives of the writing.

There are four main kinds of writing : **expository, descriptive, persuasive, and narrative**. Each kind is written for a purpose and the purpose varies in accordance with the type of writing style used.

**1. Descriptive writing**

Descriptive writing creates vivid imagery within the minds of the reader through use of sensory detail and choice of words that is descriptive. This writing is sometimes used to portray a person, place, thing, or scene. Through writing, it may make readers imagine the image created.

- **Purpose of descriptive writing**

- **Paint a picture :** Paint a picture to give readers a description of something
- **Evoke emotion :** Evoke emotion for them to see a relation between the topic and self.
- **Enhance comprehension :** Give a detailed and graphic description of the subject so that it becomes more memorable.

- **Characteristics of descriptive writing**

- **Sensory details**

- Invokes all five senses : sight, sound, smell, taste, and touch.
- **Example :** "The roses smelled like a summer breeze, their soft petals glowing crimson in the golden sunlight."

- **Figurative language**

- Employ the use of similes, metaphors, and personification to make the description richer.
- **Example :** "The mountain stood like a giant sentinel guarding the valley below."

- **Accurate vocabulary**

- Use of specific and vivid words to give exact impressions.
- **Example :** Instead of "The house was old, write "The dilapidated house, with peeling paint and creaking wooden floors, seemed frozen in time."

- **Organization**

- Descriptions should follow logical flow often moving from general to specific or focusing on key aspects one at a time.
- **Example :** From the general impression of a beach to specific details such as the grain of sand and the pounding of waves.

- **Focus on dominant impression**

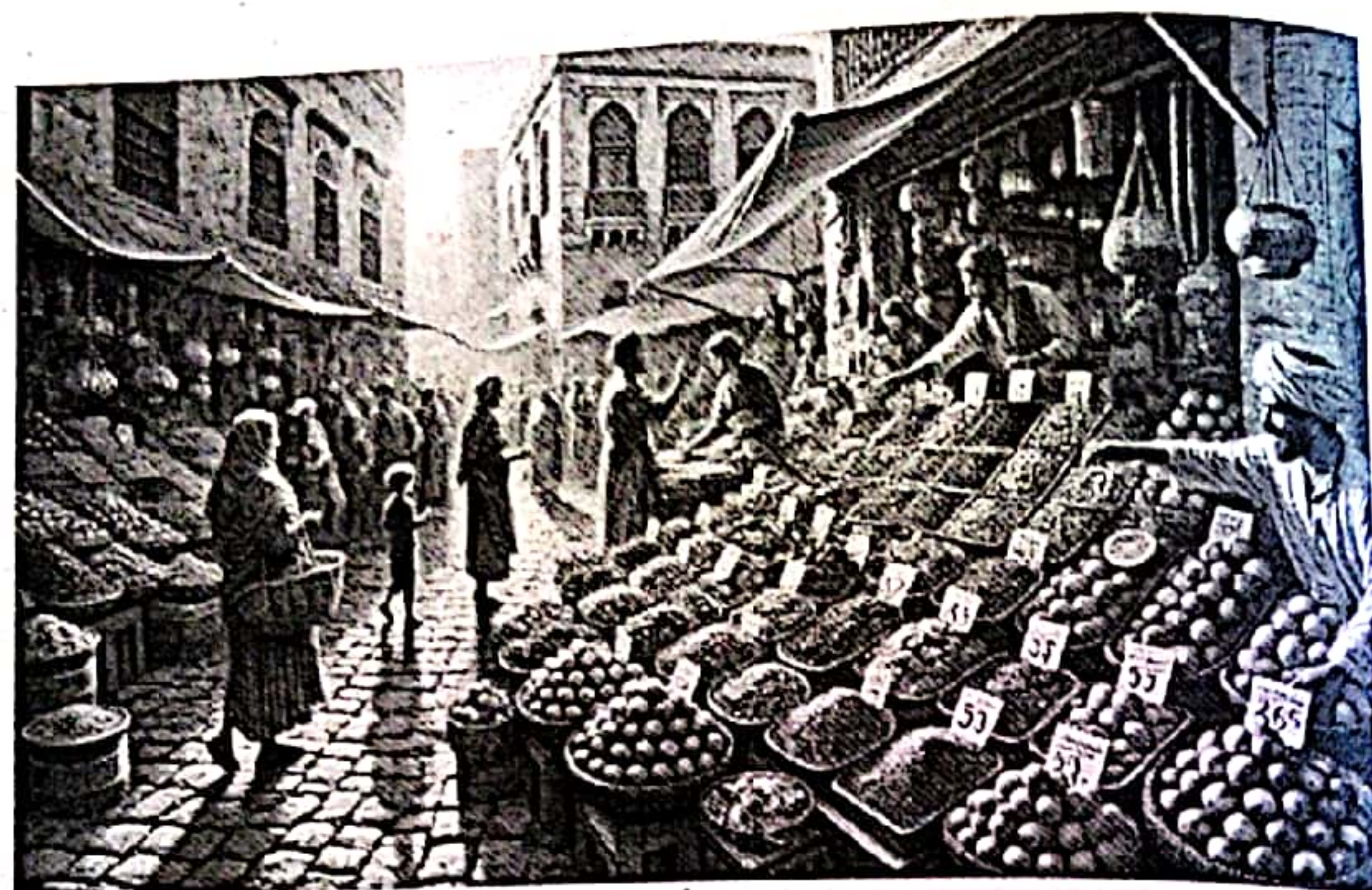
- The description should be created around a single dominant impression or feeling in the mind of the reader.

- **Strategies for a descriptive writing**

- Observe your surroundings and focus on small details.
- Use a thesaurus to find words that are specific and impactful.
- Do not overfill with too much detail; use only the most vivid and relevant ones.
- Revise your writing to ensure clarity and consistency in the imagery.

• Example : "A Vibrant Market Scene"

"The market was a kaleidoscope of colors. Bright stalls overflowed with fruits, whose sweet fragrance blended with the sharp smell of spices. Vendors called out their goods, and their voices mingled with the clinking of coins and the rustling of bags. The cobblestone streets were rough to walk on, and the warmth of the afternoon sun bathed everything in a golden glow."



2. Expository writing :

Expository writing is a formal type of writing that explains or describes ideas and concepts in an orderly and straightforward way. It is generally applied in academic, technical, and professional contexts where clarity and objectivity are of primary importance.

• Purpose of expository writing

- Explain a process or concept : Explain step-by-step instructions or detailed descriptions.
- Explain things to the audience : Give straightforward facts, information or concepts without using any kind of bias.
- Make complicated information less complicated : Subdivide difficult themes into more easy-to-understand parts.

• Characteristics of expository writing

- Logical pattern
 - Most times, expository writing has some kind of structural pattern like intro, body and conclusion.
 - Example : The recipe for how to bake a cake begins by listing ingredients. Then comes how to do them step by step.
- Objective writing style
 - Present information in neutral and factual manners, not personated or emotive.
- Use of evidence and examples
 - Uses data, statistics, or real-life examples to support the explanation.
- Clarity and Precision
 - Focuses on clear, concise language that leaves no room for ambiguity.

- Example : Instead of "Do this step carefully," write "Gently fold the egg whites into the batter to maintain its fluffiness."

▪ Focus on the reader's understanding

- Tailored to the reader's knowledge level, ensuring all necessary terms are defined and explained.

• Types of expository writing

▪ Process writing

- Defines how to do something step by step.

- Example : "How to bake a cake."

▪ Comparison writing

- The comparison between the similarities and the differences of two subjects.

- Example : "Electric cars vs. gasoline cars."

▪ Cause-and-Effect writing

- Explains reasons why something is happening and why it will keep happening.

- Example : "Effects of climate change on agriculture."

▪ Definition writing

- Gives clear and specific descriptions of terms and concepts.

- Example : "What is artificial intelligence ?"

• Strategies of Effective Expository Writing

▪ Write with a best thesis statement

- Make your purpose in writing clear within the introduction.

▪ Structuring your ideas logically

- Use headings, bullet points, or numbered lists to present information in a step-by-step way.

▪ Support using facts and evidence

- Use data, research, or examples related to the subject to make your writing credible.

▪ Break down complex ideas

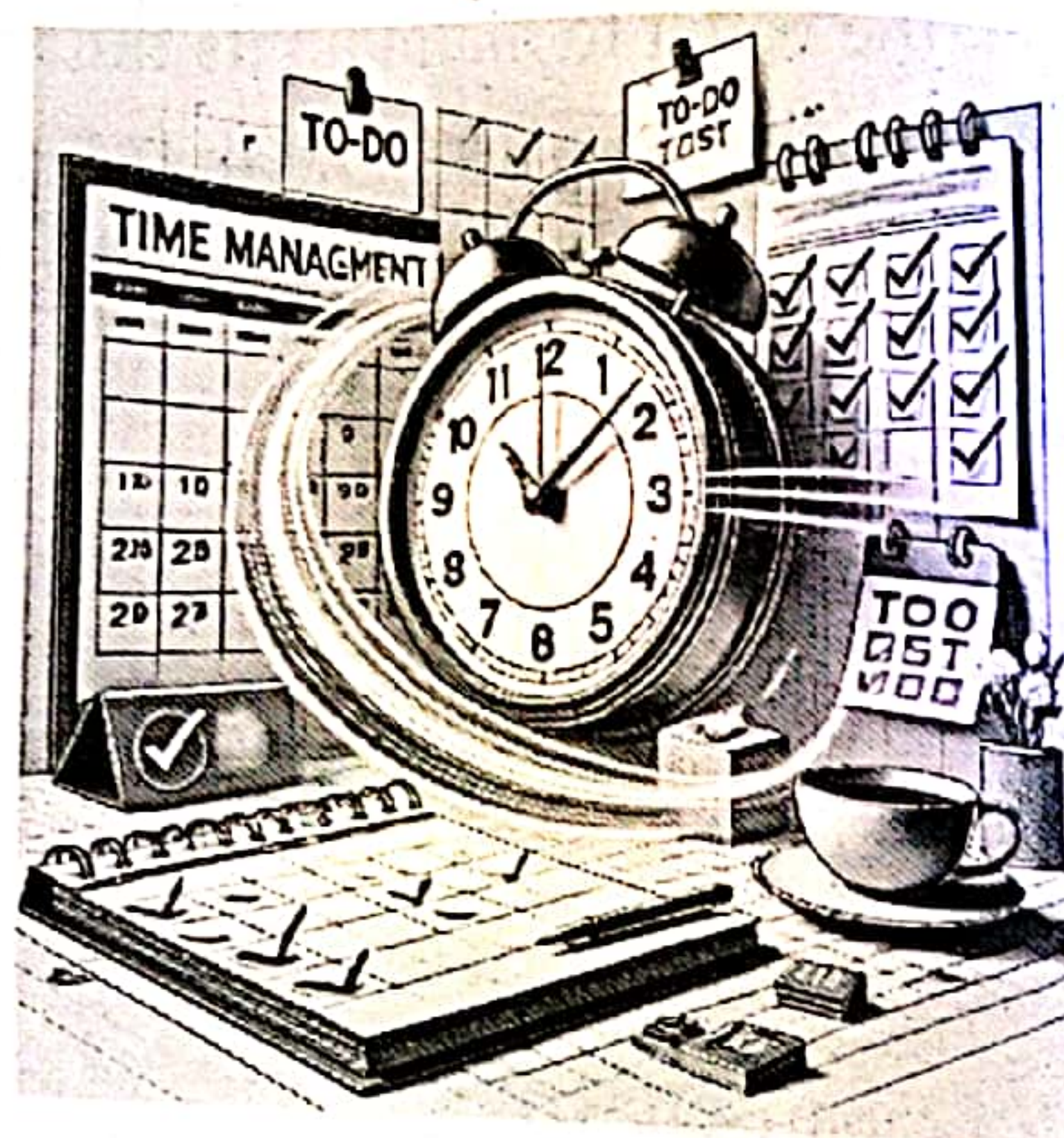
- Divide complicated ideas into smaller, manageable parts using analogies or examples.

▪ Review for clarity

- Edit your work to ensure that it is error - free and easily understandable.

• Example : "The importance of time management"

Time management refers to the organization and planning process that describes how one will distribute time for doing various things. Proper time management helps an individual accomplish more things within a very short period. This will ensure reduced stress, career success, and other many benefits. Some examples of time management tools are calendars, to-do lists, and prioritizing.



• Difference between descriptive and expository writing

Descriptive writing	Expository writing
To describe or create imagery.	To explain or inform.
Focuses on sensory details and emotions.	Based on facts and evidence.
Subjective and emotional.	Objective and neutral.
Examples : Poems, creative writing, travel descriptions.	Examples : News articles, textbooks, instruction manuals.
Frequent use of metaphors, similes, and imagery.	Minimal use of figurative language.

3. Narrative writing :

The art of storytelling is the definition of narrative writing. It entails the sharing of experiences, events, or tales with readers in such a way that their imagination and emotions are engaged. This type of writing is common in fiction, biographies, and personal essays.

• Purpose of narrative writing

The basic objective of narrative writing is to tell a story or share an experience in such a way that the reader gets involved and captivated by it. It is used for the following purposes :

- **To entertain** : Most narratives are written with the intention of making readers happy by immersing them in a thrilling story of interesting characters, vivid settings, and exciting events.

- **To educate** : It is also used to impart education through real - life experiences, historical events, or cultural stories.
- **To inspire** : Most personal or fictional narratives try to inspire the readers by their themes of survival, growth, or success.
- **Carry a message or Moral** : Mostly narratives are written to convey a greater meaning, moral, or philosophical insight to the reader.
- **Build an emotional bond** : Through narrative writing, the reader forms an emotional connection with the story, thereby empathizing with the characters and their experience.
- **Preserve memories** : Autobiographies, journals, and memoirs use narrative writing to record personal memories and significant life events.

• Characteristics of narrative writing

- **Clear sequence of events**
 - A well - planned storyline is often chronological : introduction, body, and conclusion.
 - There may also be flashbacks or foreshadowing to make it richer.
- **Characters and Setting**
 - Stories center on characters that advance the plot.
 - A clear description of the setting will allow readers to see the surroundings and setting.
- **Conflict and Resolution**
 - Each story has a conflict or challenge the protagonist faces.
 - The resolution brings closure to the story.
- **Climax**
 - The most exciting or intense part of the story where the main conflict is addressed.
- **Emotional engagement**
 - A successful narrative connects with the reader emotionally, making the story memorable.
- **Strategies for a narrative writing :**
 - Focus on a main central idea or theme.
 - Use rich descriptions to provide imagery.
 - Create suspense and curiosity to keep the audience interested.
 - Use dialogue for the characters and events' dynamism.
 - Edit your writing to ensure clarity and coherence.

• **Example : "A Life - changing Hike"**

"It was a bright morning when I decided to go for my very first solo hike. Birds chirped in harmony while the trail wound through towering trees. Little did I know, this trip was to change my perspective in life forever. Halfway down the trek, I came across an incapacitated hiker and guided him back to safety. We formed a lifelong bond."



4. **Persuasive writing :**

Persuasive writing is a style of writing that is aimed at convincing the reader to take a certain position, do something, or even agree with the writer's view. It is based on logical arguments, emotional appeals, and credible evidence in order to influence the audience.

• **Purpose of persuasive writing**

■ **Convince**

- Persuasive writing convinces the readers to accept an idea, opinion, or belief.

■ **Motivate**

- It motivates people to undertake certain actions, such as voting, donations, or changing lifestyles.

■ **Advocate :**

- An advocate supports a cause, policy, or view using sense and emotions.

• **Characteristics of persuasive writing**

■ **Strong thesis statement**

- The thesis statement should be a clear and assertive declaration that sets the writer's position.
- **Example :** "Recycling should be made compulsory in all cities to minimize waste and conserve the environment."

■ **Logical arguments**

- Reasoned points supported by facts, examples, and statistics.
- **Example :** "Plastic waste contributes to 80 % of ocean pollution, affecting marine life and ecosystems."

■ **Emotional appeals**

- Evoking emotions such as sympathy, fear, or excitement to appeal to the readers.
- **Example :** "Imagine a future where clean air and safe water become a luxury we can no longer afford."

■ **Credibility (Ethos)**

- Establish trust through credible sources, expert opinions, and ethical reasoning.
- **Example :** "The World Health Organization states that air pollution is the leading cause of premature deaths globally."

■ **Call To Action (CTA)**

- Invitation of the reader to take action from the arguments provided.
- **Example :** "Join us today in the fight against climate change by reducing your carbon footprint."

• **Strategies for persuasive writing**

■ **Know your audience**

- Know the values, concerns, and knowledge of the reader on the topic.

■ **Present logical evidence**

- Use facts, statistics, and examples to prove your point.

■ **Appeal to emotions**

- Tell stories or use imagery to evoke emotions like empathy, hope, or a sense of urgency.

■ **Counter opposing views**

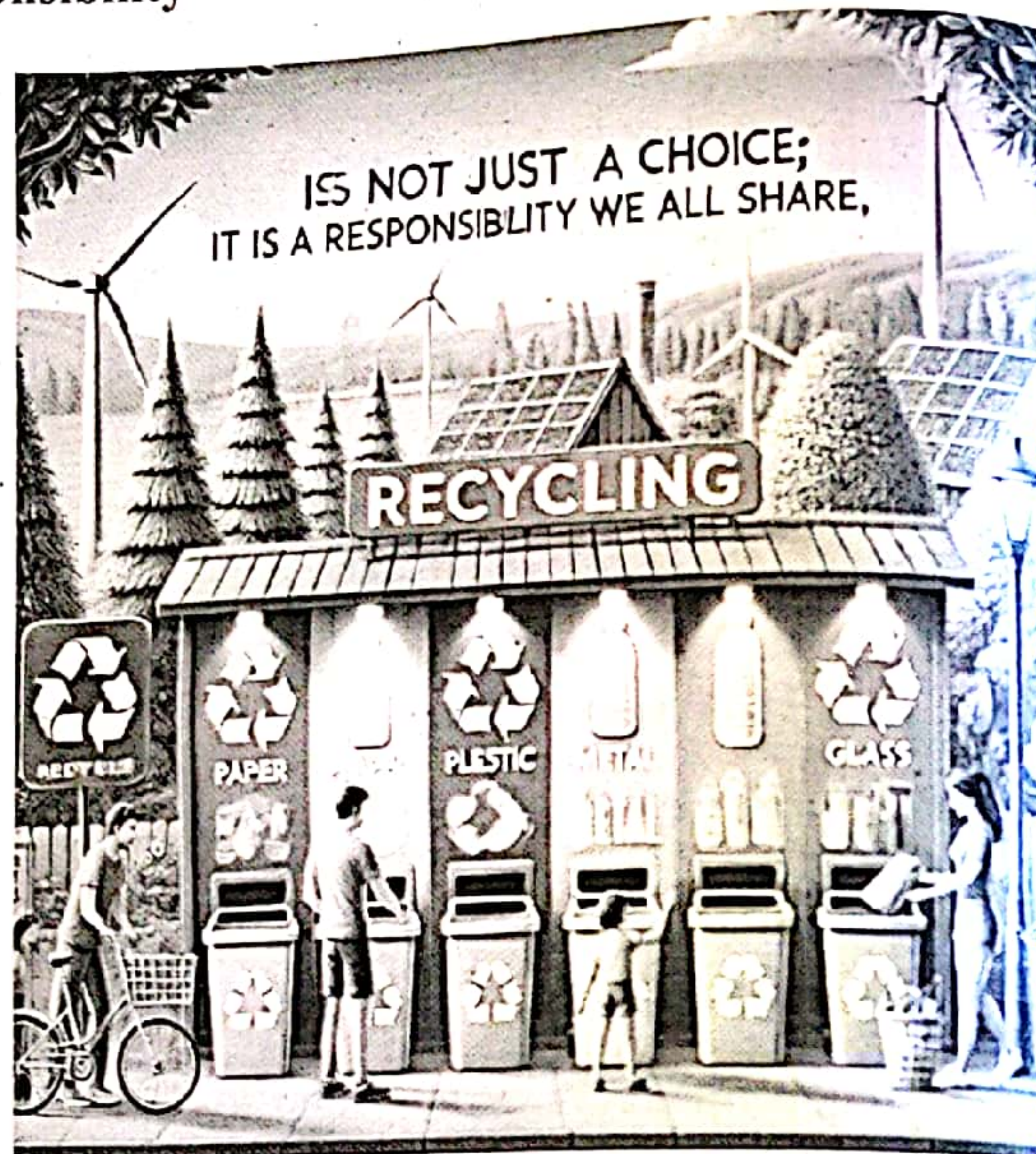
- Anticipate objections and effectively counter them.

■ **End with a strong call to action**

- Clearly state what you want the reader to do or believe.

• **Example : "Recycling : A shared responsibility"**

"Recycling is not a choice but a responsibility that we all must share. Each year, millions of tons of waste are left in landfills, releasing hazardous toxins into the air and soil. Recycling conserves natural resources, reduces pollution, and saves energy. Strong recycling programs like those in Germany have led to drastic reductions in waste. Join them today, segregate your waste, and make a long - lasting impact on our planet!"



Narrative writing	Persuasive writing
• To tell a story or recount events.	• To convince or influence the audience.
• Creative, descriptive, or reflective.	• Opinionated, logical, or emotional.
• Story - based with a clear beginning, middle, and end.	• Argument - based with evidence and reasoning.
• Examples : Novels, biographies, oral histories, short stories.	• Examples : Cover letters, advertisements, editorials.
• Evidence is central to the storytelling style.	• Evidence is minimal or extensive, depending on the purpose.

3.3 Paragraph Writing : Elements and Practice

A paragraph is a group of sentences that develop one idea or topic. It constitutes a basic writing unit, giving structure and coherence to essays, reports, and other written works. Ideally, a paragraph must state one specific idea or subject using a collection of supporting details and examples to enhance effective communication.

• **Purpose of paragraph**

■ **The purpose of a paragraph is to :**

- Express a central idea : Provide and expand on a single thought or topic
- Organize content : Divide information into usable parts
- Improve readability : Help to make the flow and coherence of a piece of writing more fluid and coherent.

• **Elements of a paragraph**

■ **Topic sentence :** The topic sentence is the keystone of a paragraph. It explicitly states the main idea and gives the reader an idea of what the paragraph will be discussing. A solid topic sentence frequently includes two components :

- **The topic :** The subject or focus of the paragraph.
- **The controlling idea :** A specific aspect of the topic that guides the content of the paragraph.
- **Example :**
- "Time management is necessary to achieve success in both personal and professional life."
- This topic sentence introduces the focus (time management) and hints at the discussion (its role in achieving success in different areas of life).
- A good topic sentence ensures clarity and relevance, keeping the reader informed and engaged.

■ **Supporting sentences :** Supporting sentences comprise the body of the paragraph. Their purpose is to explain, expand, and provide evidence to support the topic sentence. Some of the common types are as follows :

- **Explanations :** Explain the topic sentence.
- **Examples :** Some examples to explain what has to be done.
- **Facts and Statistics :** Objective data to present the argument
- **Details :** Extra information to make things more interesting.

○ **Example :**

- "If one prioritizes tasks, he can ensure that deadlines are met. He will therefore have little stress."
- This supporting sentence describes how task prioritization - a fundamental component of time management - is inherently linked with success.

○ **Additional example :**

- "According to research, people who plan daily schedules are 20 % more productive than their counterparts who do not."
- The fact therefore gives an additional strength to the main argument for credibility and depth.
- Supporting sentences closely resemble the topic sentence and ideally, avoid bringing in irrelevant information.

■ **Concluding sentence**

- The concluding sentence wraps up the paragraph, either with closure or transition to the next point.
- It can :
 - i) Summarize briefly the key point.
 - ii) Add a final touch that reinforces the idea
 - iii) Soothe the transition to the next paragraph, if it forms a part of a long piece.

○ **Example :**

- "In this way, effective time management leads to a more productive and fulfilling life."
- This conclusion reiterates to the reader through a topic sentence how time management is crucial.
- A good final sentence will take something away from the reader or introduce further information on the discussion

- **Unity :** This is how every sentence within a paragraph would cohere towards developing the topic given in the topic sentence. All sentences within this paragraph mustn't bring unnecessary information, thereby distracting from the main issue presented in the topic sentence.

- **Topic sentence :** "Healthy eating is essential to overall wellness."

○ **Supporting sentences :**

- "A well - balanced diet supplies all the nutrients your body requires to work. "
- "Eating fresh fruits and vegetables lowers your chances of having chronic diseases. "
- "Less consumption of processed foods helps with weight control and boosts energy. "
- **Conclusion :** "Therefore, good eating habits would result in living a longer life and healthier too."

- Each sentence directly supports the topic sentence with no unrelated information.

- **Coherence :** Coherence helps to make sure that sentences within a paragraph read coherently, that is logically and fluently. This can be obtained through :

- **Logical order :** Arrangement of ideas in an order which sounds logical
- **Use of transitions :** Transition words like however, therefore, in addition, and similarly help link the ideas together with enhancing readability.
- **Repetition or Paraphrasing :** Reinforcement of key terms keeps focus.
- "One effective way to manage time is by making a daily schedule." (Supporting sentence)

■ **Example :**

- "Dedicating hours to work, exercise, and relaxation can keep things in balance." (Supporting example)
- "As a result, time - conscious people will experience less overwhelm." (Concluding sentence)
- Ideas are moving logically, but with transitions like one effective way and as a result, ensure that it all flows well.

• **Organization of a paragraph**

- A paragraph is well - organized when it follows this format :
 - Topic sentence / Main idea.
 - A sentence giving an example that supports it.
 - One or two sentences that explain or illustrate the example.
 - More examples to support and their explanations.
 - Conclusion.

➤ Sample paragraph

- **Topic sentence :**
 - "A visit to the park is a refreshing experience."
- **Supporting sentences :**
 - "First, the park is full of tall, green trees that provide shade and cool air."
 - "Second, children can enjoy the playground, while adults can relax on benches."
 - "Finally, the sound of birds chirping and the sight of flowers blooming make the park a peaceful place."
- **Concluding sentence :**
 - "For such reasons, visiting the park is the best way to have fun while unwinding amidst nature."

3.4 Object / Picture / Scene Description

Describing an object, picture, or scene is one of the most important skills in writing. It requires the ability to convey visual details, emotions, and context in an engaging and clear manner. The purpose of this type of description is to paint a vivid image in the reader's mind, allowing them to imagine the subject as if they are experiencing it firsthand.

3.4.1 Object Description

Object description is an important skill in writing, allowing the writer to describe an object vividly and in great detail. It requires a keen observation of details, a sharp focus on what makes the object unique, and the ability to translate those details into words that engage the imagination of the reader.

• Elements of object description :

- **Physical appearance :** Describe all the physical aspects such as shape, size, color, texture, and material.
- **Functionality :** Describe the function or purpose of the object, if applicable.
- **Details and Patterns :** Emphasize the subtle details, patterns, or designs that make the object special.
- **Sensory impressions :** Use sensory words to describe the object's texture, sound, scent, or even taste, if applicable.
- **Historical or Emotional significance :** If the object has historical, emotional, or sentimental value, include this for a more intimate connection with the reader.

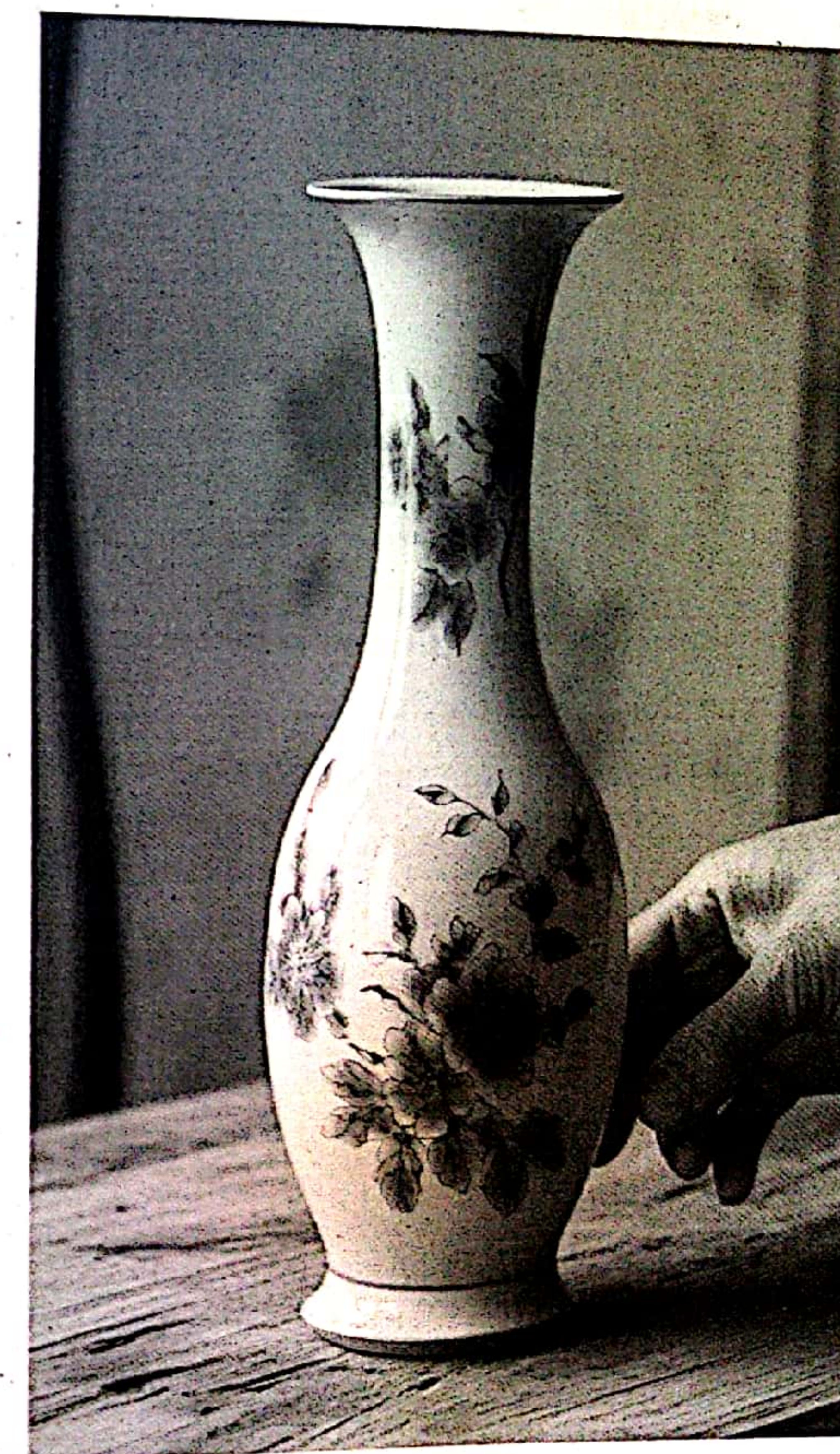
• Example of object description

The Vase

There was a thin tall vase placed upright on the table. It stood upright on its table with beautiful blue floral prints on it and its neck very narrow and tapering into a rim that was spread out to some extent, but this vase presented an aesthetic attraction.

A gentle run of a finger over its ceramic surface revealed it to be cool, smooth, with faint imperfections-ridges and uneven glazing-adding a certain charm. These imperfections whispered stories of the craft behind its creation, a perfect blend of precision and human touch.

The vase is beyond a simple decorative piece, but it has a story of artistry, care, and tradition, bearing a harmonious balance of utility and elegance.



3.4.2 Picture Description

Picture description is an important skill that helps interpret, analyze, and describe what one sees about the visual element in words. It requires carefully observing details that are translated into a narrative or descriptive format to give a mental picture to the reader.

• Key steps in picture description

- **Observation :** Look keenly at the picture and mark down the prominent elements such as people, objects, background, colors, and emotions.
- **Structuring the Description :**
 - **Introduction :** Briefly provide an overview of the picture : What is being shown (a landscape, event, or moment).

- **Description** : Detail the main components using an orderly manner - starting from the foreground to the background or vice versa.
- **Interpretation** : This part gives personal impressions, emotions, or insights that the picture might have given to oneself.
- **Use of vivid language** : Be as detailed and descriptive as possible. Use vocabulary and sensory details to make the reader visualize the image.
- **Focus on the theme or message** : Identify the central theme or message conveyed by the picture and incorporate it into your description.
- **Example of picture description**

Picture of a serene lake

The serene picture is of a lake with lush green hills surrounding it. The stillness of the water mirrors the green hills perfectly. A small wooden boat rests at the shore, with its weathered surface speaking volumes of the years it has seen. One oar lies across the boat as if beckoning someone to take a peaceful journey.



A paint of orange and pink on the sky above. The sun slowly rises as dawn begins to start. Slight ripples in the still glass - like surface of the water are caused by a pair of ducks gliding smoothly. Serenity and quietness radiate from the sight, connecting a viewer to unscathed natural beauty.

3.4.3 Scene Description

Scene description is the capturing of the essence of a moment or setting, vividly portraying its atmosphere, characters, and activities. It demands attention to detail, a structured approach, and the ability to evoke emotions and imagery through words.

- **Key elements of scene description** :
 - **Setting the context** :
 - Start by identifying where and when the scene takes place.
 - Mention whether it's indoors or outdoors, and provide a sense of time (day, night, season, or era).

■ Describing the environment :

- A description of space including weather, lights, colors, and spatial layout.
- Mood or atmosphere. Whether it is peaceful, chaotic, joyful, or tense.

■ Characters and Activities

- Introduce people or animals there with a description of their appearance, behavior, or actions.
- Interactions, movements, or dialogues add life to the scene.

■ Sensory details :

- Sights, sounds, smells, textures, even taste if applicable; to involve the reader.

■ Theme or Emotion to a focus

- Express the feeling or message of the scene so that it will be memorable and impactful.

• Scene description example

A Peaceful Park Scene

The park was silent and green. The trees stood tall and allowed their leaves to flail in the wind. Birds sang softly, and a few flowers added bright colors to the grass.

A little boy played on the swings, smiling happily as he flailed his feet. On one of the many benches in this park, there was a lady reading a book. A clear pond sat out in the open in the middle, and two ducklings were swimming gracefully.

It could be so blissfully calm to be there as well.



3.5 Précis Writing

Précis writing is the art of summarizing a piece of writing while retaining its core message and essential details. The word "précis" (pronounced pray - see) comes from the French word for "precise," and it means creating a clear, concise, and structured summary.

➤ Importance of précis writing

- **Clarity and brevity** : It teaches you to convey maximum information in minimum words.
- **Understanding** : Helps in grasping the main ideas of a text quickly.
- **Skill building** : Helps to develop critical thinking, reading, and writing concisely.

➤ Characteristics of a good Précis

- **Brevity** : The précis is much shorter than the original work.
- **Clarity** : The vocabulary used should be simple, and ideas should logically flow.
- **Accuracy** : All major points from the original work should be retained without distortion.
- **Neutrality** : Avoid adding any personal opinions or interpretation. Be faithful to the author's intention.
- **Comprehensive** : All main points and important information should be covered without including extraneous examples or explanations.

➤ Steps to write a Précis

- **Read the original text carefully** :
 - Understand the central idea and supporting points.
 - Take note of the tone, style, and purpose of the text.
- **Identify the important points** :
 - Bring out the essential details and facts.
 - Omit unnecessary or less relevant information.
- **Prepare the Précis** :
 - Write the important points in logical order.
- **Draft your précis** :
 - Start with the central idea of the original text.
 - Put into your own words the supporting points.
 - Maintain the original tone, either formal or informal.

• Revise and Edit :

- Make sure that accuracy, coherence, and grammatical correctness are observed.
- Check whether personal opinions are not included nor main ideas be left out.

➤ Précis format

- **Introduction** : Give a title, author, and central idea of the original text in one to two sentences.
- **Body** : Key points supported by details in a logical flow.
- **Conclusion** : Brief statement that reinforces the main idea.

To write a précis, it is important to follow the dos and avoid the don'ts to ensure that the summary is clear, concise, and accurate.

➤ Dos in Précis writing

1. Read the text carefully :

- Understand the main theme, tone, and supporting points.
- Read the passage several times to fully understand its meaning.

2. Identify key points :

- Highlight the main idea and important details.
- Focus on the core message while ignoring unnecessary examples and illustrations.

3. Be concise :

- Make sure your précis is roughly one - third the length of the original text.
- Write in short and clear sentences.

4. Use your own words :

- Don't copy words from the original content but paraphrase it
- Keep the tone and style of the original text.

5. Write logically :

- Presents ideas in a logical sequence that maintains coherence
- Ideas should flow logically from the start to the end

6. Keep neutral

- Don't add personal opinions, interpretations, or judgments.
- Stick strictly to the information presented in the original text.

7. Revise and Edit :

- Read your précis once again to make sure it is lucid, grammatically correct, and similar to the original.
- Ensure that all the important points are included and unnecessary details are omitted.

8. Use indirect speech :

- Rewrite the passage in third person, even if the original text is in direct speech.

9. Give a title :

- Add a short, relevant title which reflects the crux of the passage.

➤ Don'ts in Précis writing**1. Do not include examples or Redundancies :**

- Do not include 'filler' information such as anecdotes, illustrations, or examples unless they absolutely relate to the conclusion of the précis.

2. Do not use quotations :

- Do not quote sentences verbatim unless absolutely necessary.

3. Do not interject your opinion :

- Do not introduce your thoughts, beliefs, or interpretations into the précis.

4. Do not go beyond the word limit :

- Be within the set word limit; a précis must be brief and to the point.

5. Do not alter the original meaning :

- Do not change the original intent, tone, or perspective.

6. No points or Bullets :

- A précis should be a cohesive paragraph that logically flows from start to end; it should not be in the form of a list.

7. Do not skip proofreading :

- Omitting to edit your précis may result in grammatical mistakes, omission of important points, or a lack of cohesion.

➤ Examples of Précis writing**1. Original passage (148 words) :**

"The Industrial Revolution of Europe resulted in the production of huge amounts of goods, and workers started to get frustrated with their poverty. The factory owners required skilled workers, and slowly they realized that they had to be benevolent to their workforce to continue their business. Enlightened employers began to better the working conditions, and soon businesses started competing with each other to attract skilled workers. The emergence of trade unions further enhanced the conditions of workers by initiating strikes and negotiations. Today, workers have better conditions and rights because of mutual dependence between employers and employees.

Précis (49 Words) :

It transformed labor relations with improved working conditions and increased production. Enlightened employers and trade unions played a key role in securing workers' rights. Competition among businesses and organized strikes brought mutual respect between the employers and employees with better living and working standards for the labor force.

2. Original passage :

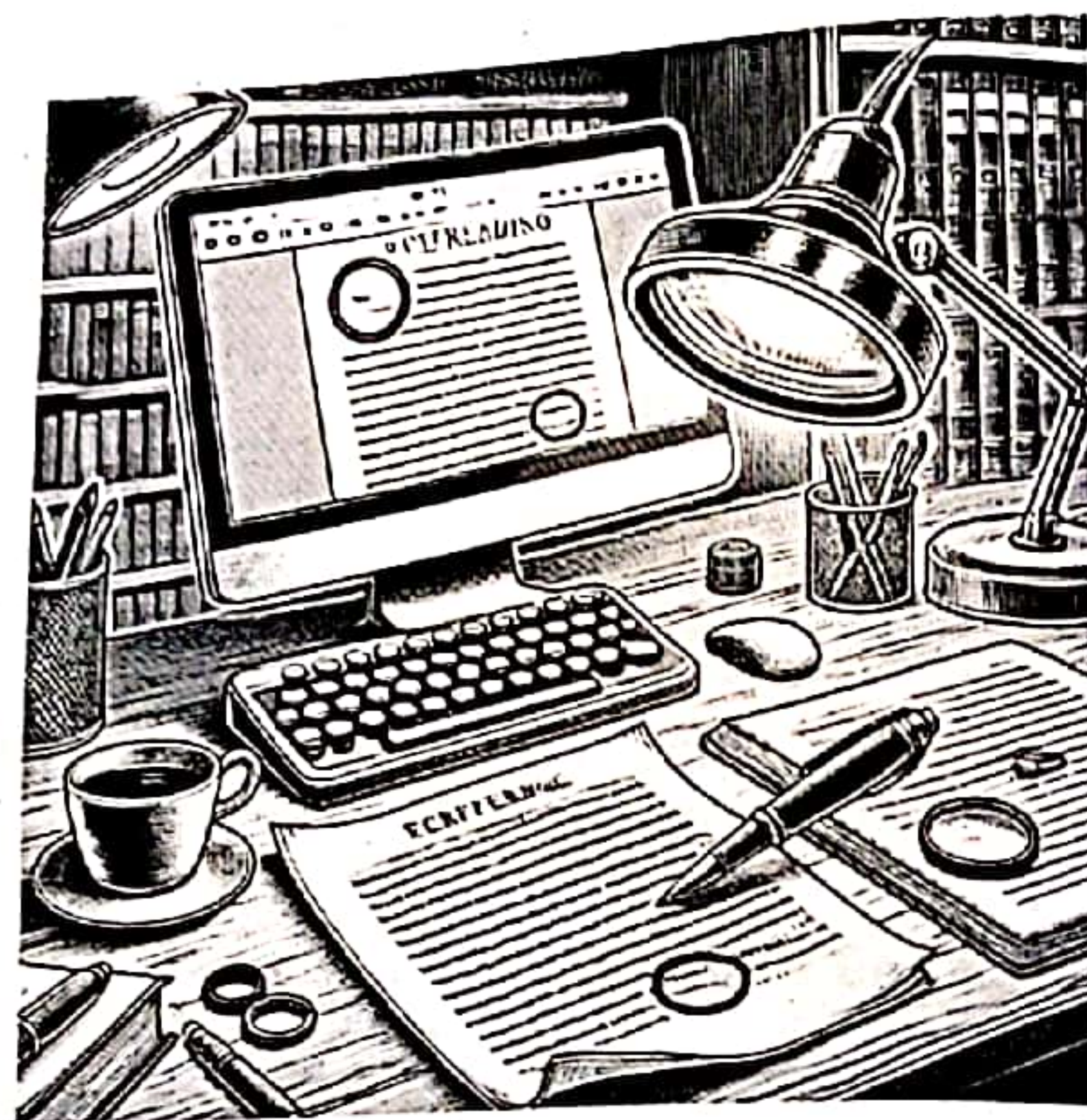
"Reading is a habit that changes our lives. It enriches our minds and broadens our understanding of the world. Knowledge and insight in books help people experience different aspects of life, cultures, and perspectives. Regular reading improves vocabulary, concentration, and boosts imagination. A habit of reading can be developed in today's fast-paced digital world as an excellent way to relax and intellectually grow.

Précis (38 Words) : Title : The power of reading

Reading is a habit that transforms the mind, broadens understanding, and develops imagination. Books provide knowledge, cultural insights, and improved vocabulary. In this digital age, reading regularly brings relaxation and intellectual growth.

3.6 Proofreading

Proofreading is carefully reviewing any printed or written document to detect grammar, spelling, punctuation, format, and content errors. It represents the final process of editing whereby the text comes out polished and professional and totally free from any errors. Proofreading is quite essential in safeguarding the integrity and impact of written communication both for personal and official purposes. This is the last phase of the editing process and ensures the document is accurate for publication or presentation.



➤ What is Proofreading ?

Proofreading refers to checking the text carefully for typographical errors, grammatical mistakes, inconsistencies in style, and problems in formatting. The goal of proofreading is to polish the document so that it is clear, professional, and suitable for its intended audience.

➤ Types of proofreading

Proofreading is one of the essential steps in the editing process, which helps to ensure accuracy, clarity, and consistency in written content. There are different types of proofreading, depending on the specific purpose and type of document. Below are the common types of proofreading :

- **Academic proofreading** : This is concerned with academic literature like research articles, theses, dissertations, and other journal articles. It ensures the proper citation styles (APA, MLA, etc.), reference style, accuracy in data, conformance to scholarly standards, and proper spelling standards. Academic proofreading is highly important for academic documents to stay clear and precise.
- **Translation proofreading** : Translation proofreading is the checking of translated texts to ensure that they accurately reflect the meaning of the original source. It requires knowledge of both the source and target languages. Proofreaders address common translation challenges, such as grammar issues, cultural nuances, and incorrect phrasing. The aim is to ensure that the translation is precise and culturally appropriate.

- **Print media proofreading** : Print media involves proofreading within newspapers, magazines, books, and journals. Typically, this category of proofreaders is responsible for removing typographical errors, rephrasing for grammatical / spelling errors, and formatting documents correctly. Most importantly, check the layout that includes margins, fonts, spacing, and formatting to ensure that this print or web-based material represents a professional grade.
- **Business proofreading** : Business proofreading is reviewing business documents such as reports, proposals, emails, and marketing materials. The main focus is on professionalism, clarity, accuracy, and consistency in tone and language. Business proofreaders also ensure adherence to company style guides, improving the quality and effectiveness of business communication.
- **Technical proofreading** : Technical proofreading is on technical documents such as user manuals, guides, and engineering reports. The accuracy of technical terms, figures, and data is guaranteed by the proofreaders. This type of proofreading ensures that the text is free of errors and readable, especially if the content is complex.
- **Legal proofreading** : Legal proofreading specializes in legal documents, such as contracts, agreements, and policies. The proofreaders ensure proper usage of the legal terminology and check for mistakes while confirming the document's language is precise and clear. The legal proofread also ensures there are no inconsistencies or ambiguities in the document's clauses and terms.
- **Creative proofreading** : Creative proofreading for works of fiction, poetry, screenplays, and other pieces of creative writing uses the same practice as above with a focus on consistency in narrative, accuracy with names and timeline of characters, and the desired tone of writing. It's also checking out for grammatical errors and all - round readability.
- **Scientific proofreading** : Scientific proofreading is the process of proofreading scientific papers, lab reports, and research articles. The purpose is to ensure that the terminology is precise, data is correctly represented, and the paper adheres to scientific standards. It also checks that complex scientific concepts are explained in a clear manner and the document follows the journal's specific guidelines.
- **Digital content proofreading** : Digital content proofreading is concerned with online materials, including websites, blogs, and social media posts. Proofreaders ensure that the content is clear, engaging, and free of errors. They also check proper formatting, the use of hyperlinks, and readability across devices and platforms, ensuring that the content is optimized for online audiences.

➤ Importance of proofreading

- Improves clarity and professionalism :
 - It eliminates errors that may confuse readers or undermine the credibility of the writer.
 - It ensures that the content is well polished and professional in nature.
- Improves accuracy :
 - All facts, figures, and references are checked to be correct.
 - Inconsistencies in style, formatting, and tone are detected.
- Builds confidence in communication :
 - It ensures that the writer is communicating ideas clearly and effectively.
 - The proofreading also shows attention to detail and quality commitment.
- It prevents miscommunication :
 - It rectifies errors which may change the meaning or intention of the text.
 - The content will then meet the intended message.

➤ List of common proofreading symbols and their meanings

Symbol	Name	Meaning	Example
#	Insert space	Add a space between two words.	"bookstore" → "book store"
Stet	Let it stand	Ignore the correction; keep the original text.	Marked text remains as is.
l.c.	Lowercase	Change to lowercase.	"HELLO" → "hello"
U.C.	Uppercase	Change to uppercase.	"hello" → "HELLO"
Del	Delete	Remove the marked word or phrase.	"He is is tall." → "He is tall."
Trs.	Transpose	Swap the order of words or letters.	"can you" → "you can"
^	Insert	Add missing text or punctuation.	"She loves books" → "She loves reading books."

New para	New paragraph	Start a new paragraph.	Indicates a division in content or ideas.
No ¶	No paragraph	Do not create a new paragraph; continue.	Keep the content in the same paragraph.
?	Query	Clarify unclear or doubtful text.	"He went to ?? on Monday."
Sp	Spelling	Indicates a spelling error.	"recieve" → "receive"
/	Change to italics	Convert text to italic style.	"important" → <i>important</i>
=	Equalize spacing	Fix inconsistent spacing.	"word word" → "word word"
NP	New page	Start a new page at this point.	Insert a page break.
B.F.	Boldface	Change text to bold.	"attention" → attention
Ctr.	Center	Center - align the text.	Align headings or titles to the center.
Caps	Capitalize	Capitalize the marked letter(s).	"london" → "London"
Insert ¶	Insert paragraph mark	Add a paragraph break where indicated.	Create a new paragraph.
Close up	Close space	Remove extra space between characters or words.	"book store" → "bookstore"
Trans.	Transpose words	Rearrange words as marked.	"fast too" → "too fast"
" "	Single quotation marks	Add single quotation marks.	'word'
" "	Double quotation marks	Add double quotation marks.	"word"
X	Omit	Delete the marked portion of text.	Remove unnecessary words or phrases.
.	Insert full stop	Add a period where indicated.	"End of sentence" → "End of sentence."
,	Insert comma	Add a comma at the specified location.	"We ate dinner and dessert" → "We ate dinner, and dessert."

;	Insert semicolon	Add a semicolon.	"He runs she walks" → "He runs; she walks."
:	Insert colon	Add a colon.	"List includes apples bananas" → "List includes: apples, bananas."
-	Insert dash	Add a dash for emphasis or clarification.	"He said yes no" → "He said yes—no."
^ ^	insert text	Add missing words or letters.	"The cat sat the mat" → "The cat sat on the mat."

➤ Steps of proofreading process

• Preparation :

- The print out of the document for visibility
- Quiet place of the workplace to concentrate

• First read through :

- Scan the entire paper for an overview of its contents and flow
- Pick out obvious sections or regions that require focus

• Common errors :

- Spelling, punctuation, grammatical
- Proper sentence construction and meaning

• Consistency check :

- All headings, font and line space used are similar
- Style used should be the same, especially for capitalization, abbreviations and terms

• Check facts :

- Correctness of date, statistics, references, and names.
- Cross-check citations or hyperlinks to make sure they are valid and correct.

• Check for redundancy and repetition :

- Remove unnecessary words, phrases, or repetitive ideas.

• Read aloud :

- Read the text aloud to catch awkward phrasing or unnatural flow.
- Helps catch errors that may not be apparent when reading silently.

• Use tools and resources :

- Utilize grammar and spell - checking software for initial error detection.
- Refer to style guides (e.g., APA, MLA) if applicable.

• Take breaks :

- Take a break from the document for some time and then proofread it with fresh eyes.

• Final read-through :

- Read through the document one last time to make sure there are no errors left.
- Pay attention to the overall presentation and readability of the document.

➤ Common mistakes found during proofreading

• Spelling mistakes :

- Misspelt words or inappropriate word usage (i.e., "their" instead of "there").

• Grammar and syntax mistakes :

- Subject-verb agreement or inappropriate use of tenses or misplaced modifiers.
- Comma and apostrophe or inappropriate quotation mark usage.

• Formatting mistakes :

- Irregular headings, fonts, or misplaced spaces.

• Repetitions / redundancies :

- Repetition of ideas or phrases in your writing.

• Logical mistakes :

- Gaps in reasoning, contradictory statements, or vague transitions

• Incorrect reference works :

- Incorrect citations, bibliographies, and hyperlinks or URLs.

➤ Tips for effective proofreading

- **Work in a quiet environment :** Eliminate distractions to concentrate solely on the text.
- **Print the document :** Reviewing a hard copy may help catch errors that are overlooked on a screen.
- **Check one element at a time :** Focus on one type of error, such as grammar, before moving on to the next.
- **Proofread backwards :** Start from the end and read each sentence individually to spot spelling and grammatical errors.

- **Use a checklist** : Make a check list of frequently occurring mistakes that can be avoided during proofreading. Get another person to glance through the text.

➤ Proofreading at work place

Proofreading happens to be essential in professional sectors as it brings about quality expression. Some include;

- **Business writing** : Emails and reports, pitches, and speeches.
- **Publishing** : Articles or books, posts on blogs or newsletters.
- **A piece of college work** : Papers, theses, research writings, and submissions for grants
- **Advertising** : Jingles, adverts, brochures, as well as pieces for social networks.

➤ Rules for effective proofreading

- **Doubt an area first** : Verify all things with the potential to be incorrect, such as numbers and names.
- **Read slowly** : Understand every word in addition to all punctuation marks and formatting elements
- **Checklist** : Make a checklist so that no area is missed (e.g., grammar, spelling, formatting)
- **Proofread at least twice** : At least read the document twice, once to give attention to one aspect each time.
- **Seek a second opinion** : If possible, have another person review the document for fresh insights.
- **Mark clearly** : Use proofreading symbols or notes to highlight errors for correction.

3.7 Completion of a Given Story

Story completion is a writing activity that builds imagination, reasoning, and narration abilities. The person is given an incomplete story that they have to complete in their own words such that the completion is both logical and coherent. Story completion is quite popular in most creative writing sessions, classes, and literary activities in terms of the stimulation of imagination and sharpening of writing skills.

Story completion is the continuation and conclusion of a partially written narrative in such a way that it retains its original tone, style, and logical flow. It involves analysis of the given text, developing a consistent progression of events, and providing a satisfying conclusion that resolves conflicts or questions posed in the story.

➤ Importance of story completion

- **Enhances creativity** : Completing a story encourages out-of-the-box thinking, and it allows individuals to come up with innovative ideas and creative solutions. It fosters imaginative thinking and the ability to invent new plot twists or character developments by crafting an engaging continuation.
- **Builds logical thinking** : This helps in building up a plot aligned with the presented plot. In this, very careful consideration about the sequence of events is involved, so as to make a logical flow for the story. Critical thinking and capability to connect coherent ideas are promoted through this.
- **Enhances the writing ability** : Story completion develops the ability to use descriptive language, build characters, and write realistic dialogues. Practicing these skills helps in developing better storytelling abilities and making the story more vivid and engaging.
- **Develops attention to detail** : Completing a story teaches the importance of maintaining consistency in tone, characters, and setting. Paying attention to these details ensures the story remains cohesive, making it more believable and enjoyable for the reader.

➤ Steps for completing a given story

- **Read and understand the given story** : Begin by reading the given part of the story carefully. Be attentive to the characters, setting, and events that have happened. Note conflicts or open situations that need resolution.
- **Analyze the story elements** : Explain and break down the main elements of the story- the theme, mood, and the central conflict. Determine what was not explained or remained unsolved. This will aid in determining what to do next.
- **Brainstorm possible directions** : Consider various directions the story might take. Reflect on several different endings and plots. This should foster creativity, and the end will be coherent with the rest of the tone and theme of the story.
- **Create an outline** : Plan the direction of the story. Decide what events will happen next, how they will unfold, and how the conflict will be resolved. This outline will help organize the flow of ideas and ensure the narrative is logical.
- **Write the continuation** : Start writing the continuation of the story. Be flexible with your outline and take off in a new direction when inspiration strikes. Stick to your original plot and characters as much as possible.
- **Keep it logical and consistent** : Ensure that the story flows naturally from the given part to your continuation. Use transition words and phrases to maintain a smooth progression. Pay attention to pacing so the narrative doesn't feel rushed or disjointed.

- **Address the conflict :** Resolve any conflicts or questions raised in the given part of the story. Whether it's a problem between characters or an external challenge, provide a satisfying conclusion that feels earned and meaningful.
- **Use descriptive language :** Add details that make the story come alive. Use sensory language, vivid descriptions, and realistic dialogue to immerse the reader in the scene. This will make the story more engaging and relatable.
- **Revise and Edit :** After completing the story, read through it and make revisions. Check for consistency in tone, character behavior, and plot development. Look for grammatical errors or awkward phrasing, and refine the narrative to ensure clarity.
- **Finalize the story :** Give a final read to your story after revisions. Check that the story flows and that the end feels complete. Do any last adjustments and finalize it for sharing or submission.

➤ Example

Complete the given story

It was stormy and a wet night when Sarah was coming back home from the office. There was very heavy rain so it was getting quite hard to drive further as everything on the road seemed to merge in the falling droplets. At one instance, her car skidded off, and Sarah lost all her control. Soon her car met a tree in such a pace that everything seemed dark for a few moments.

Read and Understand the given story :

The story sets a suspenseful and tense mood. It introduces Sarah, who is facing an unexpected and dangerous situation-a car crash during a storm.

Analyze the story elements

Key elements :

Character : Sarah

Setting : Stormy night, Sarah driving home, crash into a tree

Conflict : The crash and Sarah losing consciousness

The conflict is unresolved, and we don't know whether Sarah is okay or what happens next.

Brainstorm possible directions

- Sarah wakes up in the hospital.
- After the crash, she is rescued by someone.
- Crash results in a mysterious encounter with a stranger

Create an outline

- Sarah wakes up to find herself confined in the car.
- She tries to free herself from the wreckage. The storm creates a lot of problems for her.
- A figure appears in the rain and takes her out from the wreckage.
- Sarah finds that the stranger had saved her in time.

Write the continuation

Sarah slowly cracked open her eyes. The pain made her head difficult to focus upon. Her car was wrecked, and she was wedged into the driver's seat, a seat belt tightened over her upper torso. She felt panic take hold as she tried to struggle to move from where she sat.

She had almost given up when she saw a figure walking through the rain. The stranger didn't utter a word, but he swiftly and carefully pulled her out of the car.

"You are going to be okay," the man said, his voice calm despite the storm.

Sarah did not know who he was, but at that moment, she felt an odd sense of comfort.

Keep it logical and consistent

The flow from the unconscious Sarah to her becoming conscious is smooth. The appearance of the stranger seems mysterious but rationalizes within the storm and crash scenario.

Address the conflict

The conflict in the story that Sarah is stuck in the car is resolved by the stranger. A new question now arises, though : Who is the stranger ? The ending is open to a lot of possibilities.

Use descriptive language

The description of the storm, the car wreckage, and the figure coming out from the rain would really paint vivid pictures in the reader's mind.

Revise and Edit

The review of the text shows that the events and the actions of the characters appear consecutive and logical. The suspense mood is maintained in the story without the interruption of unnecessary details.

Finalize the story

The story ends with a mysterious rescue, leaving room for further development or an intriguing sequel. The narrative is complete and compelling.

The Stormy Night

It was a stormy night, and Sarah was driving home after a long day at work. The rain was falling so hard that she could barely see the road. Suddenly, her car lost control and crashed into a tree. Everything went dark.

When Sarah woke up, she felt a sharp pain in her head. She was stuck in her car, unable to move. The rain was still pouring, and she felt scared and alone.

Just then, she saw someone walking towards her through the rain. The person didn't say anything, but quickly opened the car door, unbuckled Sarah's seatbelt, and helped her out of the car.

"Don't worry. You're safe now," the person said calmly.

Sarah was confused and didn't know who the stranger was, but she felt comforted by his words. The stranger helped her to a nearby cabin to stay out of the rain. Inside the cabin, Sarah was still shocked but felt better.

"Thank you for helping me," Sarah said. "Who are you?"

The stranger smiled but didn't answer. He simply looked out the window, as if waiting for something.

Sarah closed her eyes, feeling tired but safe. The storm was loud outside, but she felt a strange peace inside the cabin. She didn't know who the stranger was, but she was thankful he had saved her.

3.8 Letter Writing (Formats, Asking for Leave, Apology, Appreciation, Acknowledgement)

Letter writing is a skill used both in the personal and professional fields to communicate issues, request actions, convey emotions, or simply to inform people formally or informally. In formal communication, a well-written letter is somewhat crucial in maintaining professionalism, clarity, and respect.

Here we focus on the different types of letters and their respective formats, including asking for leave, apology, appreciation, and acknowledgment letters. Each of these types has its respective format and tone, depending upon the nature of the message. Understanding the right structure for these letters will enable you to express your intentions correctly and

appropriately. Writing a formal and respectful letter is a fundamental skill in communication whether you are addressing a superior, a colleague, or a friend.

What is letter writing ?

Letter writing is the expression of thought, ideas, or information in a written structured format to be addressed to a person or organization. It is an official or unofficial form of correspondence which may convey information, make requests, apologize, express gratitude, and maintain personal contact among others. Depending on the purpose and audience involved, letters can be classified as formal, informal, and semi-formal.

Format of Formal Letter

[Sender's Address]

[Date]

[Receiver's Address]

[Salutation / Greeting]

[Subject]

[Body of the Letter]

- Introduction
- Main Content
- Conclusion

[Closing Statement]

[Signature]

[Full Name]

[Designation] (if applicable)

[Enclosures] (Optional)

3.8.1 Format of a Formal Letter.

The format of a formal letter is usually standardized to ensure clarity and professionalism. Here is a standard format for writing formal letters :

1. Sender's address :

- This is your address, placed at the top left corner of the letter. It should include your street address, city, state, and zip code.
- If you're using letterhead, you can omit this section.

2. Date :

- Date, this is below the sender's address. Should be written in formal format like, January 14, 2025

3. Recipient's address :

- Comprise the recipient's name, designation, company or institution name, street address, city, state, and zip code of the person or organization you're addressing. Below the date is placed

4. Salutation/Greeting :

- The first line of the letter. An address given to the recipient. Most common Greetings include :
 - "Dear [Mr./Ms./Dr./Prof. Last Name]," if you are writing a formal letter.
 - "To whom it may concern," if you do not know the recipient's name.

5. Subject (Optional but Recommended) :

- A line that summarizes what the letter is about. It should be concise and clear, such as "Request for Leave," "Apology for Missing the Meeting," etc.

6. Body of the letter :

- **Introduction** : Clearly state what your letter is about.
- **Main content** : Include as much detail as possible, stating the main reasons for writing.
- **Conclusion** : Summarize the key points and, if necessary, request a response or suggest further action.

7. Closing statement :

- A polite phrase to end the letter. Examples are :
 - "Yours sincerely," (when you know the recipient's name)

- "Yours faithfully," (when you don't know the recipient's name)
- "Best regards," (informal or semi-formal)

8. Signature :

- Leave space for your signature in case you have to print it.
- Write your full name under the signature line. If you are writing on behalf of an organization, you must write your designation below your name.

9. Enclosures :

- In case you have included any document(s) along with the letter, mention the same here like "Enclosure : Resume".

3.8.2 Layouts of Letters

In business letters, the layout (or format) varies depending upon the organization or the formality of the letter. The four most common layouts include block format, modified block format, semi-block format, and simplified letter format. The formats differ mainly in their textual alignment and placement of certain elements.

1. Block format

- Indentation of paragraphs : Not indented.
- Text alignment : All texts are aligned to the left.
- There is no center and right alignment for any part of the letter.

2. Modified block format

- Paragraph indentation : No paragraph indentation.
- Text alignment : The sender's address, date and closing are right-aligned.
- The body text remains left-aligned.

3. Semi-block format

- Paragraph indentation : Paragraphs are indented (typically 0.5 inches).
- Text alignment : Same as modified block, with the body left-aligned.

4. Simplified letter format

- Paragraph indentation : No paragraphs are indented.
- Text indentation : All text is left-aligned.
- Salutation : Not used in basic business letter format
- Subject line : Used with basic business letter format.

1. Block Format	2. Modified Block Format
Sender's address	Sender's address
Date	Date
Receiver's name	Receiver's name
Address	Address
Dear _____	Dear _____
_____	_____
_____	_____
Closing word(s)	Closing word(s)
Typed signature	Typed signature

3. Semi-Block Format	4. Simplified Letter Format
Sender's address	Sender's address
Date	Date
Receiver's name	Receiver's name
Address	Address
Dear _____	Subject: _____
_____	_____
_____	_____
Closing word(s)	Closing word(s)
Typed signature	Typed signature

3.8.3 Asking for Leave

Asking for leave is a common aspect of professional and academic communication; asking for leave is essential in such cases. Personal reasons, illness, or other circumstances may make it necessary to request leave in a formal and respectful manner. A well-written leave request letter should clearly state the reason for taking time off, specify the dates, and express gratitude for the recipient's consideration. By following an appropriate format along with a polite tone, you could ensure that it is taken quite seriously and absence is acknowledged at the right hour.

123 Main Street,
Surat, Gujarat, 390000

January 10, 2024

To,
The Principal,
A.K Engineering College.
Surat, Gujarat, 390000

Subject : Request for Leave

Respected Sir,

I am writing to inform you that I am feeling unwell and would like to request leave from school from 13th January 2024 to 15th January 2024. I would be grateful if you could kindly grant me leave for the mentioned period.

Thank you for your time and understanding. I look forward to your approval.

Yours sincerely,

Smith

Smith John

Roll No. 240001

Mo. 9997778811

3.8.4 Apology

An apology letter is written to express regret or to offer an explanation for a mistake, misunderstanding, or inconvenience caused. It should be sincere and show acknowledgment of the issue while taking responsibility for the actions that led to the situation.

In an apology letter, it is crucial to be truthful and assure the recipient that his or her concerns are being attended to in order to achieve respect from the recipient.

123 Main Street,
Mumbai,
Maharashtra - 400001

April 5, 2023
Mr. Sam Smith
Manager, MNC Corporation
456 Business Ave,
Mumbai, Maharashtra, 400005

Subject: Apology for Missing the Meeting

Dear Mr. Smith,

I am writing to sincerely apologize for missing our scheduled meeting yesterday. Unfortunately, due to an unforeseen emergency, I was unable to attend. I understand the importance of the meeting and realize my absence may have caused inconvenience to you and the team.

I assure you that this will not happen again, and I will take all necessary steps to ensure I am more punctual in the future. I would appreciate the opportunity to reschedule the meeting at your convenience.

Thank you for your understanding and patience.

Yours sincerely,

Karan

Karan Malhotra
Jr. Assistant

3.8.5 Appreciation Letter

An appreciation letter is written for gratitude and recognition of someone's efforts, contributions, or support. It serves as a method to acknowledge the efforts of a person and pay respect to his or her work or kindness. A well-written appreciation letter strengthens professional and personal relationships.

An appreciation letter must be specific as to what has been done and the positive impact it has had. Showing authentic gratitude helps build strong relationships, both professional and personal.

ABC Colony,
Main Street,
Karnatak,
Bangalore-29.

12th January 2025

To,
Mr. Anil Kumar,
ABC Enterprises.
Karnataka,
Bangalore-29

Subject: Appreciation for Excellent Support

Dear Mr. Kumar,

I am writing to express my heartfelt appreciation for your exceptional support during the recent project. Your dedication, hard work, and attention to detail ensured that everything ran smoothly and that we met our goals ahead of schedule.

Your proactive approach and leadership were key in bringing the project to success, and I truly value your contributions to the team. It was a pleasure working with you, and I look forward to collaborating again in the future.

Thank you once again for your outstanding work.

Best regards,

John

Mr. John Smith
Head of Department

3.8.6 Acknowledgment Letter

An acknowledgment letter is written as confirmation of receiving something, like a document or any form of payment, or even a request. It is sometimes used to show appreciation and confirmation that the deed has indeed been done. A well-written acknowledgment letter establishes trust and clarity in professional and personal communication.

In an acknowledgment letter, it must be clear and concise, assuring the receiving party that an item or information has been received. Acknowledgment letters contribute to a professionalism and reliability feel in communication.

➤ Example of Acknowledgment Letter

15th January 2024

To,
Ms. Priya Gupta,
XYZ Publishing,
Delhi - 110088.

Subject: Acknowledgement of Manuscript Submission

Dear Ms. Gupta,

This is to acknowledge the receipt of your manuscript titled "Communication Strategies." We have received it in good condition, and it is currently under review by our editorial team.

We will contact you once the review process is complete.

Yours sincerely,

John Doe

Mr. John Doe

Head of Department

Review Questions

1. What are the four main styles of writing? Explain in brief of each. (Refer section 3.2)
2. List the key characteristics and purposes of narrative writing. (Refer section 3.2)
3. How does persuasive writing differ from narrative writing in terms of objectives and structure? (Refer section 3.2)
4. Describe the role of sensory details and figurative language in descriptive writing. (Refer section 3.2)
5. What are the main elements of a good paragraph? (Refer section 3.3)
6. Describe how a topic sentence is important to paragraph writing. Use an example to illustrate your response. (Refer section 3.3)
7. How can transitions enhance the coherence of a paragraph? (Refer section 3.3)
8. What are the key elements of an effective object description? (Refer section 3.4)
9. Outline the steps involved in crafting a detailed scene description. (Refer section 3.4)
10. How does picture description differ from scene description? (Refer section 3.4)
11. Define précis writing and explain its importance in communication. (Refer section 3.5)
12. List the steps for writing an effective précis and describe any two. (Refer section 3.5)
13. Why is proofreading considered a crucial step in the editing process? (Refer section 3.6)
14. Describe any two types of proofreading mentioned in the document. (Refer section 3.6)
15. What are common mistakes found during proofreading? (Refer section 3.6)
16. Why is story completion considered an essential skill in creative writing? (Refer section 3.7)
17. List the steps involved in completing a given story and explain how brainstorming helps in this process. (Refer section 3.7)
18. What are the components of the format of a formal letter? (Refer section 3.8)
19. Prepare an apology letter for bad behavior. (Refer section 3.8)
20. How would you structure a leave request letter? (Refer section 3.8)
21. What is the purpose of an acknowledgment letter, and how does it contribute to professionalism? (Refer section 3.8)
22. Your cousin's sister is getting engaged and you have to attend the function at Mumbai. You are Sohan, a student of Jain Engineering College, Mumbai. Write a letter to the Head of Department for a leave of two days. (Refer section 3.8)

3.9 University Questions with Answers

- Q.1 Discuss about the tips for writing a good paragraph. (Refer section 3.3)
GTU : March-23, Marks 3
- Q.2 Write a paragraph on 'India in 2022' in about 300 words. (Refer section 3.3)
GTU : March-23, Marks 7

Q.3 What are the principles of writing good paragraph? Discuss in brief.
(Refer section 3.3)

GTU : Aug.-23, Marks 4

Q.4 What is the importance of coherence in a paragraph? (Refer section 3.3)

GTU : Jan.-24, Marks 3

Q.5 Explain 'topic sentence' with an example. (Refer section 3.3)

GTU : Jan.-24, Marks 3

Q.6 What are some effective strategies for crafting engaging introductions and impactful conclusions in a paragraph? (Refer section 3.3)

GTU : July-24, Marks 4



Unit 4

4

Speaking Skills

Syllabus

Introduction to Phonetics, IPA, Place of articulation, transcription, Presentation skills- an introduction, Analyzing audience and locale, Organizing a presentation, Introduction to group communication, Conversations, Debates, dialogues, and GDs, (Suggestive list of words for Phonetic Transcription is available in the link. provided.)

Contents

- 4.1 Introduction to Phonetics
- 4.2 International Phonetic Alphabet
- 4.3 Places of Articulation
- 4.4 Presentation Skills
- 4.5 Introduction to Group Communication
- 4.6 Communication Style in Conversations / Group Communication
- 4.7 University Questions with Answers